

Judgment, not generation.

Maker Compass is the step before the build: it turns a rough idea into the market context, product plan, first-version scope, mockups, and technical direction a serious builder needs before writing code.

PRIMARY SEGMENT

Founders and indie builders carrying one specific idea they have not turned into a real first version. They can already generate code. What they cannot do is decide which version of the idea deserves the next three months.

TRIGGER

Starting feels messy. Tools, prompts, and feature possibilities have created motion without direction.

SECONDARY SEGMENTS

Product-minded operators who need to pressure-test an idea before asking for headcount.

Technical consultants who scope other people's ideas and need the reasoning legible to a client.

THE WEDGE

Everyone else competes on how fast software can be produced. We compete on whether it was worth producing.

ANCHOR PERSONA

Priya, 31

A senior engineer with a side project she has restarted four times. Each restart began with a different framework and ended in the same place: a repo with authentication, a settings page, and no answer to who it is for.

She does not need help writing code and finds "AI builds your app" pitches insulting. She wants to cut the idea down to something she can put in front of ten people in three weeks.

REFERENCE BRANDS — BORROW THIS

Stripe	Measured calm. Dense information without anxiety; documentation treated as a designed product.
Basecamp	Opinionated restraint stated out loud, and a willingness to lose the customers who disagree.
Aesop	Typographic discipline. Warm neutrals doing the work colour usually does.
Field Notes	Paper as the honest medium of thinking. Utility that looks like utility.